

an intro to

AYAAN AHMED



WHAT I LIKE

I love photography, creating videos, and designing things that visualize my abstract and/or complex ideas.

I love animation and illustrated art. I grew up on Cartoon Network, Pixar and Superhero movies, I also love dinosaurs and cars.

I like soundtracks from movies and games, especially by Michael Giacchino, John Powell, Christophe Beck, and C418.

I like burgers, Indo-Chinese food, my mom's home cooking, and specifically Kellogg's Coco Pops cereal produced in the Middle East (Tastes different elsewhere).

Tokyo / 2022

SOME OF MY PHOTOGRAPHY

I like photographing landscapes, cities and wide areas- when I'm lucky.. This was taken from the top of the tallest building in Japan: the Tokyo Skytree

Toronto Islands / 2024



Glenfinnan Viaduct / 2025



Expo City Dubai / 2023



Lately I've been doing more animal photography, it's
a lot harder than most types of photography, but I've
got some amazing shots in zoos and farms.



Cheetah / 2025



Eagle / 2025



Deer / 2025



Raccoon / 2024



WHY GRPH-4015?

I really enjoyed developing some projects in Graphic Design 4: which introduced a lot more flexibility, but also a lot more critical complexity than in other courses.

Workshop 1 seems to really bring that forward, and further stretch it out to my entire final year at OCAD, in which I really want to make something I enjoy, as well as something I can be proud of in a capstone manner.

It's a lot more independent, but also adds on a larger load with larger expectations, but I'm willing to take up the challenge and create some interesting things.

MY WORK

I've created a number of varying types of work in and out of OCAD in the last few years.

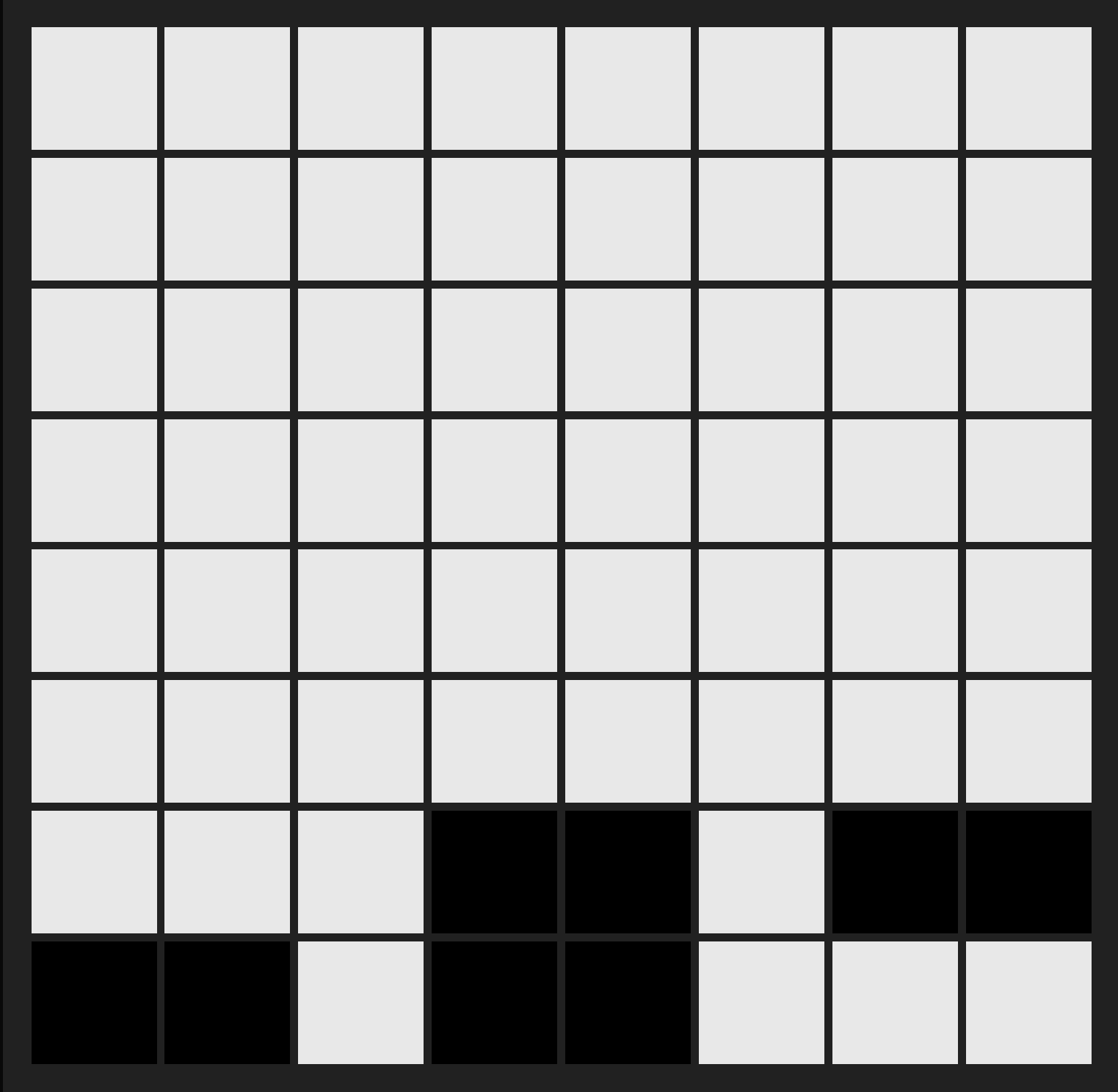
They range from poster, editorial and web design to complex narrative data visualizations and typography.

The works below in order are: (1) It's a Small World, a visualization of how interconnected I myself can be if you consider how loosely we consider meeting celebrities can become. (2) Finite Grids, a mathematical grid ticking through every variation of an 8x8 grid with an unthinkable ending. (3) Bhopali, a font I designed named after Bhopal, the city I was born in. (4) Flying Colors, one of numerous posters I designed for university based on airplane livery designs. (5) Blue Tiger Inc Studios, my personal YouTube channel on which I've been creating documentaries lately.

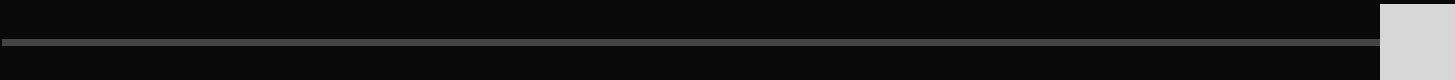
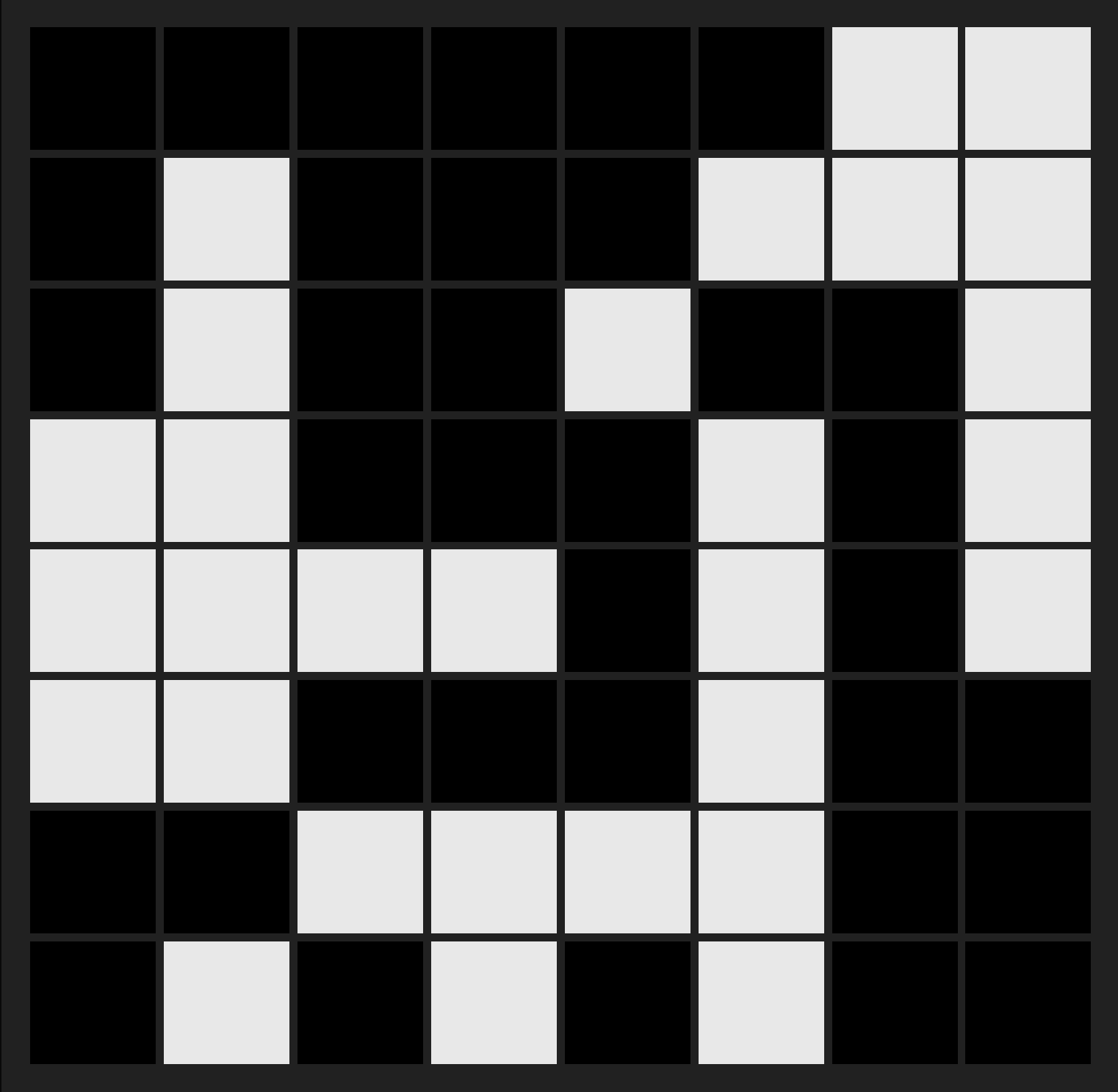
It's A Small World / 2026



ORDERED



RANDOM



A B C D E F G H I
J K L M N O P Q R
S T U V W X Y Z

a b c d e f g h i j k l m
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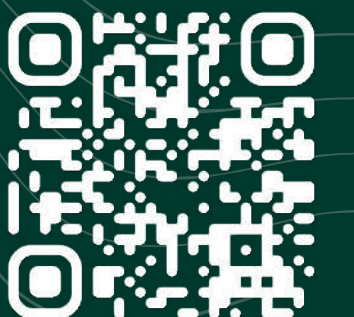
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f Bhopali

by Ayaan Ahmed

Bhopali is a display serif typeface designed for strong visual impact. Inspired by elements from my birth-city of Bhopal in Central India. It combines smooth serifs, sharp edges, and a solid bold weight which creates a distinctive rhythm across letterforms. Perfect for use at larger sizes, to give a luxurious feel, and reflect organic curves in a unique, stylized design.



FROM THE COLLECTION OF THE INTERNATIONAL AVIATION BRANDING ARCHIVE

FLYING COLORS

THE ART OF AIRLINE BRANDING

JAN 1 2026 - FEB 1 2026

ART GALLERY OF ONTARIO

Flying Colors soars into the world of modern airline branding, from the 2000s onwards. Exploring how bold liveries, striking iconography, and vibrant palettes turn aircraft into flying canvases, each telling a story of identity and history.

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FROM THE COLLECTION OF THE INTERNATIONAL AVIATION BRANDING ARCHIVE

FLYING COLORS

THE ART OF AIRLINE BRANDING

My Documentaries /
2023-2024



Blue Tiger Inc Studios

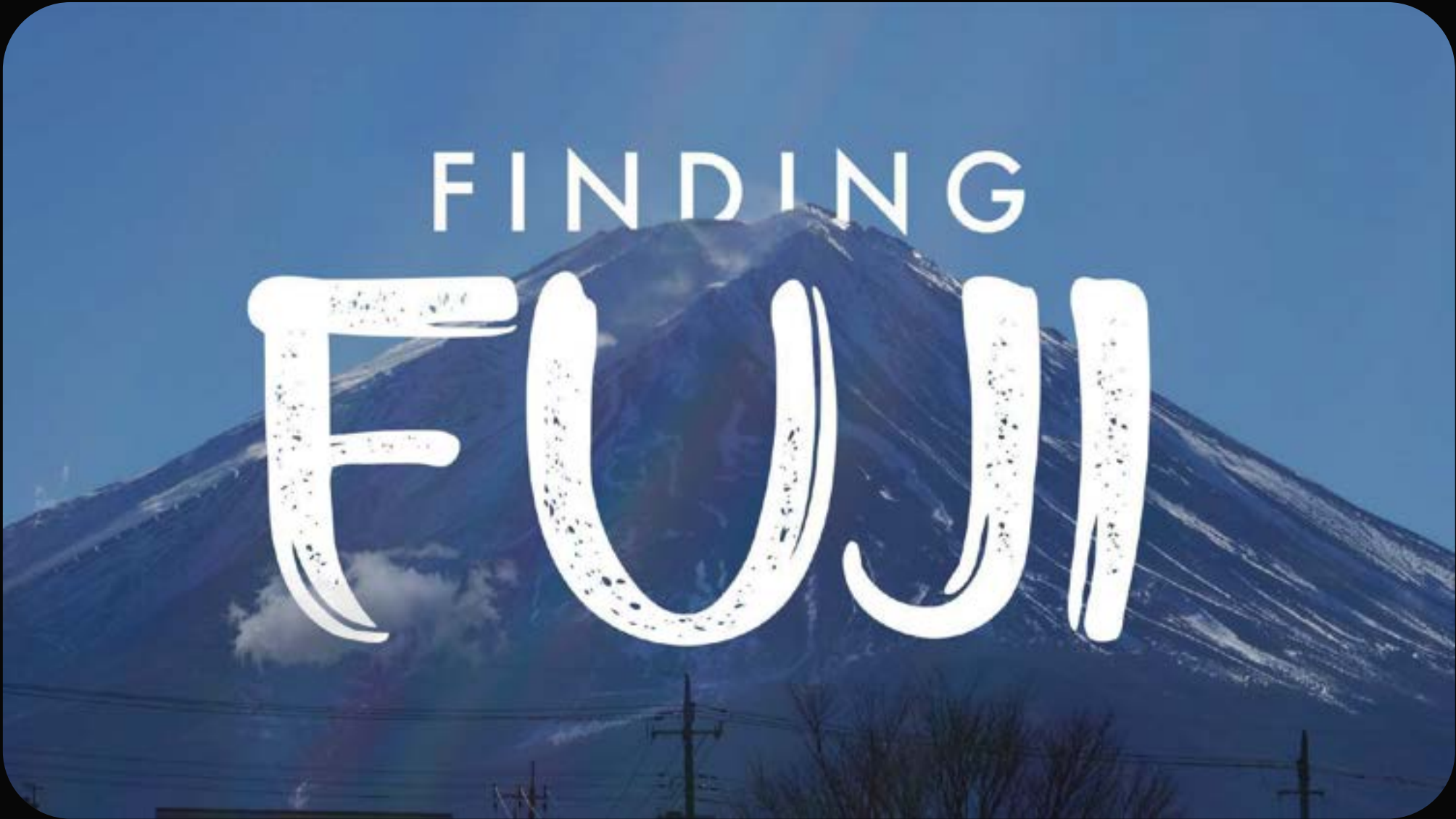
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WHAT I WANT TO DO

The sky's the limit. I'm interested in a lot of things, and have a lot of ideas.

I have a list of potential projects I've been writing for months in the off chance I might suddenly need new ideas, among which a lot of vague and concrete bases can emerge from.

I have interests in photography, data visualizations, map-based visuals, identities and theming, and on a theoretical level, I often have ideas surrounding the connection of unlikely things together, the display and outlaying of the perception of time, the perception of scale, and my own place in the world as someone from many different places.



CONCRETE BASES

Maps & Cartography

Maps intrigue me, they are essentially a data visualization of the very world around us and designing using them, for them and around them is very interesting to me.

Visualizations

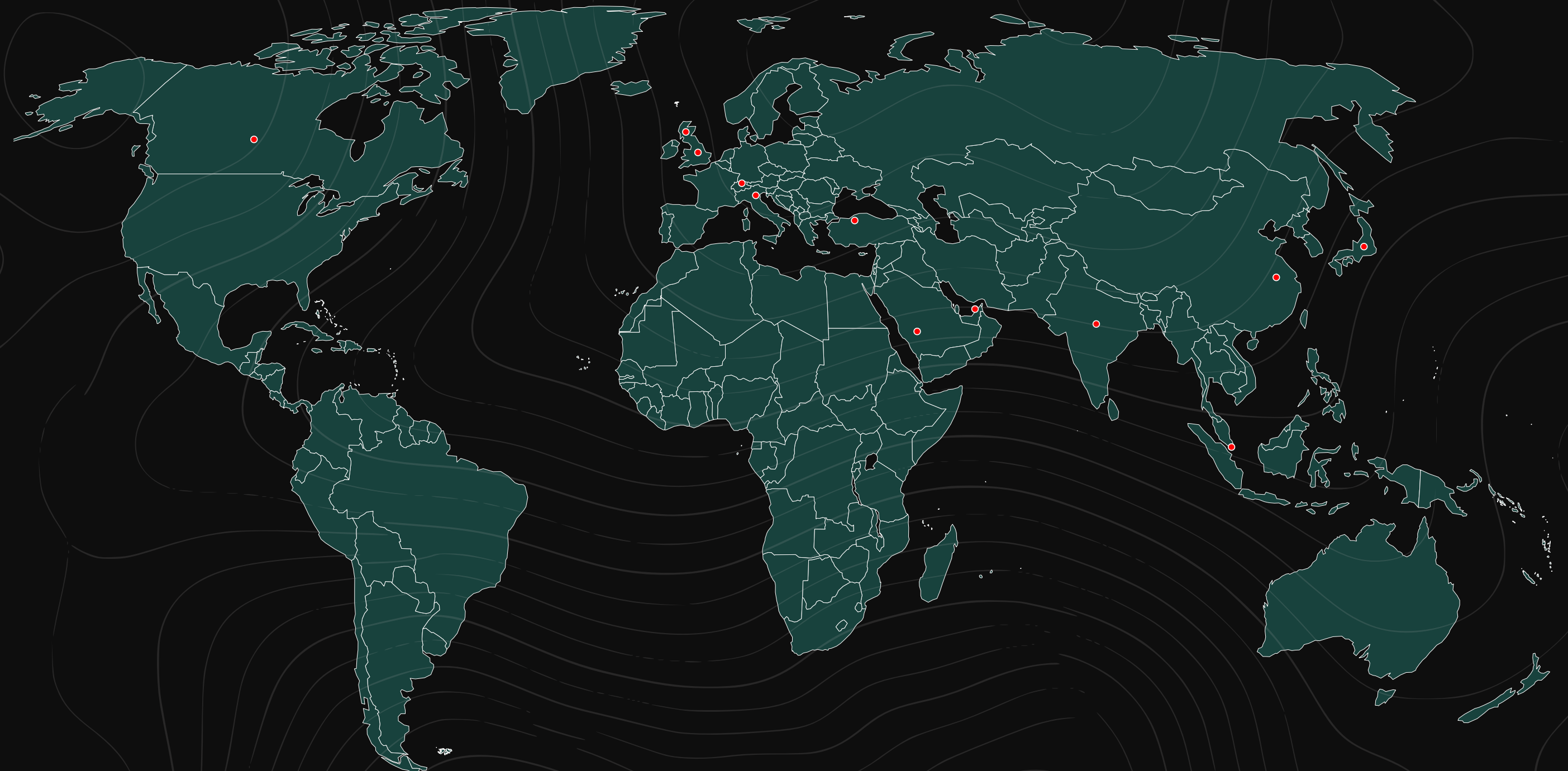
Creating visuals of data, time and other elements create an aesthetic display I've useful as a primary design piece.

Photography

Using images of my own is something I hope to bring to my project, I take various styles and genres of photographs and I hope I can incorporate them in some way.

Identities

My real-world design experience often involves designing the identities of both my own work and the identities of other entities.



THEORETICAL CONCEPTS

The Connection of Unlikely Things

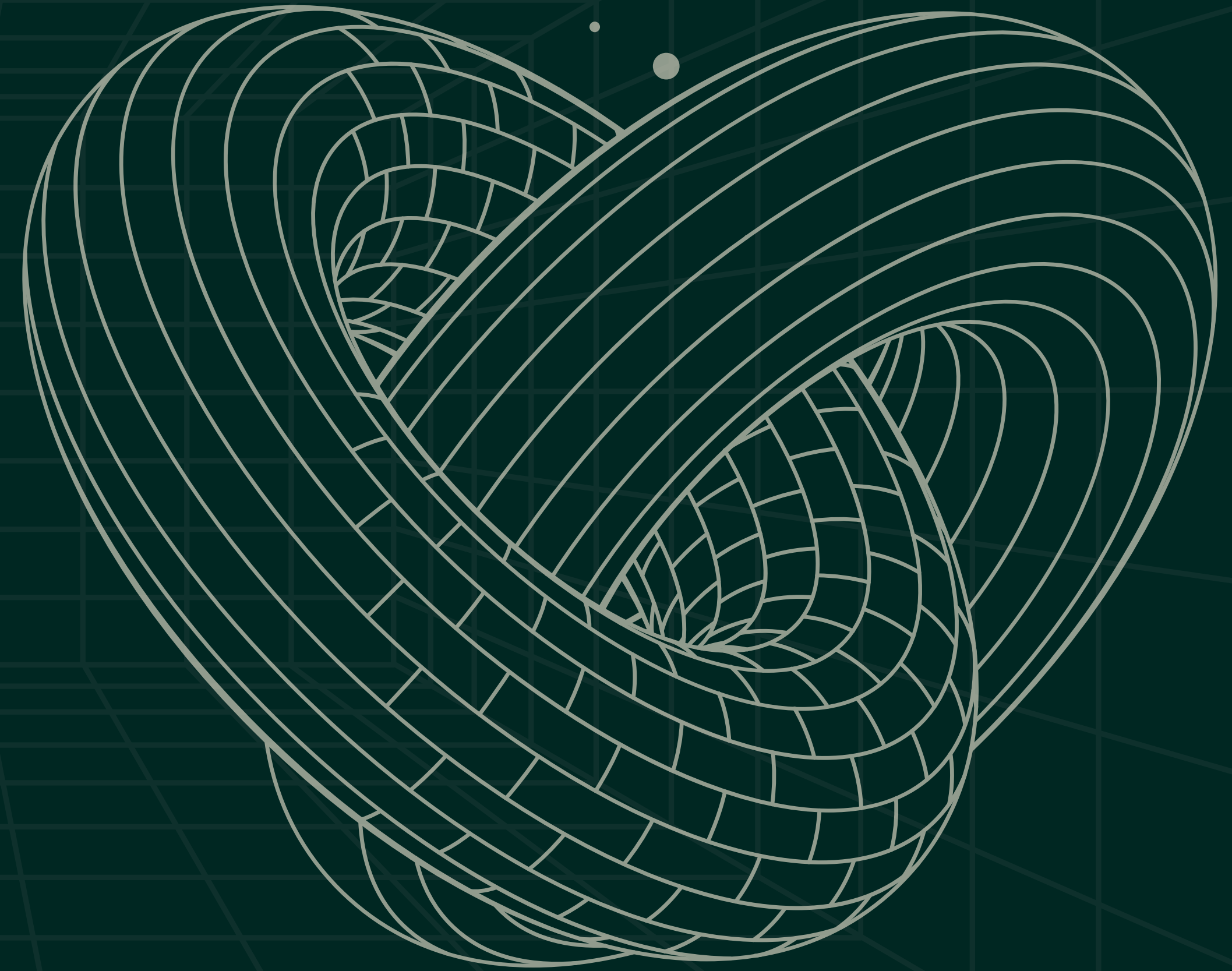
This is an amalgamation of about 20 different ideas I've had, connecting things that you'd never think to fit together fascinates me, an example being how Dopey from Disney's Snow White has been the logo of a local burger chain in Sharjah, UAE for the past 30 years, it's so uncanny but totally real.

Perception of Scale & Time

Scale and Time is something I also love to design and bewilder with, something like how Instagram stores all the data for every user's activity adding up to over 400,000 petabytes, and how Cleopatra was more likely to have an iPhone than witness the creation of the pyramids.

My Own Place on Earth

A topic I often think about, I was born in one country, grew up in another, and then live in another and have travelled around 3 separate continents, the experiences and differences create a strong narrative.



so that's

**AYAAN
AHMED**

